

PLUMB

A floor-pricing partner for ad ops. Statistics propose, an agent can refuse, a human decides.

PROBLEM

Price floors are set by hand, on a belief, with no way to see the curve

Too low

Money left on the table in every auction

Too high

Auctions go unfilled and revenue drops

No signal

A bidder outage, demand surge or reporting glitch looks like a trend

In sample data, modelled manual pricing captures 78.7% of the available revenue and makes a harmful move on 16.3% of decisions.

SOLUTION

Three parts, each doing only what it is good at

1

Statistics layer

Fits revenue per 1k requests against log floor over 21 days. Step is capped and shrinks when confidence is low.

2

Agent that can refuse

Reads ops notes and data-quality signals. Returns a trust plan, never a price. Refuses on thin traffic, flat floors, outlier days.

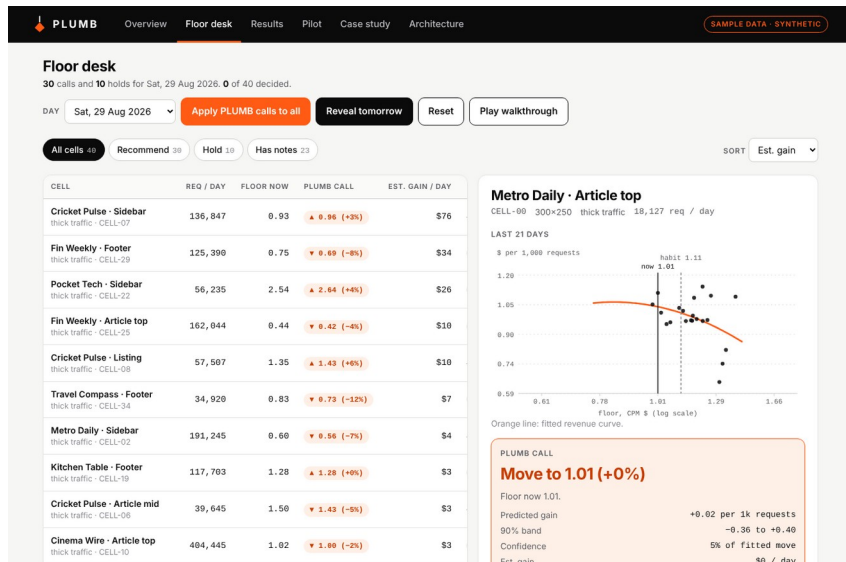
3

Human decides

Every recommendation sits in a queue with its evidence. Ops accepts, edits or rejects, and the reason is logged.

PRODUCT DEMO

A working web app and a clickable demo



Decisions
Every accept, hold and override, with who made it and why. This is the audit trail, and the override rate is what a pilot reads.

SUMMARY: DECISIONS 40, ACCEPTED 30, HELD 9, OWN FLOOR 1, OVERRIDE RATE 3.2%

Export decisions CSV

TIME	BY	DATA THROUGH	CELL	ACTION	FLOOR NOW	PLUMB CALL	FINAL	REASON
2026-10-09 20:37:15 UTC	ops	2026-09-27	CELL-38	Accepted	3.81	3.34	3.34	
2026-10-09 20:37:15 UTC	ops	2026-09-27	CELL-37	Accepted	1.84	1.43	1.43	
2026-10-09 20:37:15 UTC	ops	2026-09-27	CELL-36	Accepted	0.78	0.72	0.72	
2026-10-09 20:37:15 UTC	ops	2026-09-27	CELL-35	Held	5.22	held	5.22	Held: PLUMB refused. insufficient_signal: thin traffic
2026-10-09 20:37:15 UTC	ops	2026-09-27	CELL-34	Accepted	1.54	1.44	1.44	
2026-10-09 20:37:15 UTC	ops	2026-09-27	CELL-33	Accepted	1.50	1.21	1.21	
2026-10-09 20:37:15 UTC	ops	2026-09-27	CELL-32	Accepted	0.44	0.42	0.42	
2026-10-09 20:37:15 UTC	ops	2026-09-27	CELL-31	Accepted	2.74	2.42	2.42	
2026-10-09 20:37:15 UTC	ops	2026-09-27	CELL-30	Accepted	1.52	1.34	1.34	
2026-10-09 20:37:15 UTC	ops	2026-09-27	CELL-29	Accepted	2.62	2.40	2.40	
2026-10-09 20:37:15 UTC	ops	2026-09-27	CELL-28	Accepted	3.98	3.52	3.52	
2026-10-09 20:37:15 UTC	ops	2026-09-27	CELL-27	Held	5.75	held	5.75	Held: PLUMB refused. insufficient_signal: thin traffic

Web app: decision log with reasons, CSV in and out

Floor desk: evidence beside every recommendation

plumb-floor-pricing-demo.vercel.app | github.com/Johnbritt/Plumb-Floor-Pricing

TRACTION

What exists today, all verifiable in the repo

40 x 180

sample cells and days, with events and ops notes

6

arms evaluated, scored on a held-out world

100

test runs per pilot design, plus A/A placebo

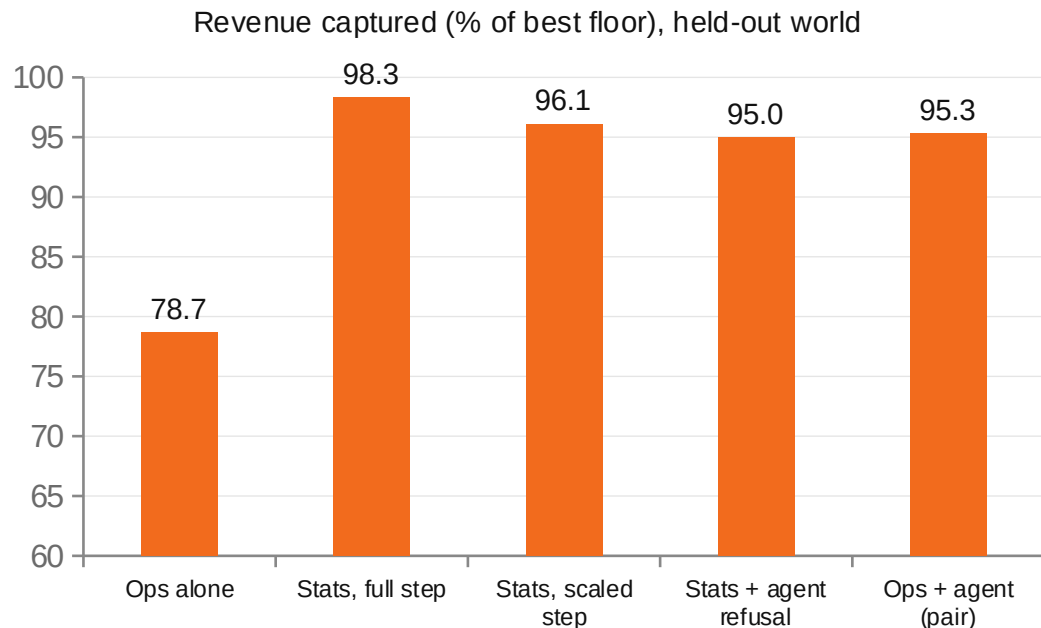
11

automated tests, CI passing on GitHub

Next: a matched-cell pilot with real ops colleagues. Success criteria are already written and checked on sample data.

RESULTS ON SAMPLE DATA

The statistics layer does the work. Refusal buys safety.



Harmful moves

Ops alone 16.3%. Unguarded stats 6.2%.
Guarded 2.6% to 3.0%.

What did not hold

The agent stand-in did not beat a plain rule. The pair did not beat the model alone. Both stay open until the Claude backend is run.

The findings changed the design four times

Scope

Started as a VAST/GAM discrepancy adjudicator, narrowed to floor pricing where the decision and the outcome are both measurable

v1

Hard significance gate refused 82% of days and cost 1.7 points. Replaced by a confidence-scaled step

Metric

Exploration jitter made held floors look harmful. Harm redefined: move over 10% and revenue down over 1%

Findings

Refusing thin cells freezes learning. Holding during an outage can hurt

Pilot

Tested the pilot design itself: 20 cells for one week passes 26% of the time. Redesign to 40 cells, 4 live weeks

TEAM

One builder, product and engineering in one head

J John Britto

Head of Product & Technology, Bengaluru

- 8+ years in AdTech, from UI/UX designer to Head of Product & Technology
- Built ad servers, header bidding, OpenRTB exchange and reporting pipelines
- Leads backend, frontend and data engineers, and the roadmap
- PLUMB built solo: problem, statistics, agent design, evaluation, app

Statistics propose. The agent can refuse. A human decides.

Demo: plumb-floor-pricing-demo.vercel.app

Code: github.com/Johnbritt/Plumb-Floor-Pricing